Celebration-from-Plan Checklist — Nurses Week

A low-cost plan you can actually pull off between shifts. May 6-12 — and honestly, any week works.

Check boxes as you go. Potluck + printables + a little dollar-store magic, done.

3-4 weeks out — plan it (30 minutes, coffee optional)

- [ ] Pick the date(s) during Nurses Week (May 6-12) that fit the schedule
- [ ] Set a budget per person (aim low: $3-8 covers everything below)
- [ ] Ask whoever approves things for permission + break-room space
- [ ] Post the potluck sign-up sheet on the unit board + break room
- [ ] Recruit 1-2 helpers per shift — don't carry this alone
- [ ] Scout dollar-store decor and small prize loot on one trip

Week of — set the scene

- [ ] Print thank-you cards (preceptor + coworker sets) and badge tags
- [ ] Assemble the banner: cut flags, spell it out, hang near the break room
- [ ] Fill a low-cost snack basket: tea, cocoa, fun bandages, granola bars
- [ ] Queue a sticky-note shout-out wall for staff
- [ ] Confirm potluck coverage: who brings what, who covers the phones

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Day of — keep it easy

- [ ] Set out cards + pens where people actually pause (break room, med room)
- [ ] Badge tag stand: pick a tag, tape it on, tag a friend
- [ ] Run the potluck: label items, assign a drinks-watch person
- [ ] Snap photos for the unit board / private group (never patient info)
- [ ] Draw any raffle winners (gift card, fuzzy socks, coffee run)

Wrap-up — 15 minutes

- [ ] Return borrowed items; recycle plates and cups
- [ ] Thank helpers by name — a card from this pack counts
- [ ] Jot down what worked + what to skip for next year
- [ ] File extra printables for year-round birthdays and thank-yous